

Swimmy

Searchable transcript

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Source: `Swimmy (Lionni, Leo, 1910-1999, author, artist) (Z-Library).pdf` (36 PDF pages; story on PDF pages 6-33)

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> Internal school working copy prepared from a school-accessible PDF. Keep with the restricted book files. Do not publish this transcript in GitHub, Supabase, or the public progress viewer.

A happy school of little fish lived in a corner of the sea somewhere. They were all red. Only one of them was as black as a mussel shell. He swam faster than his brothers and sisters. His name was Swimmy.

One bad day a tuna fish, swift, fierce and very hungry, came darting through the waves. In one gulp he swallowed all the little red fish. Only Swimmy escaped.

He swam away in the deep wet world. He was scared, lonely and very sad.

But the sea was full of wonderful creatures, and as he swam from marvel to marvel Swimmy was happy again.

He saw a medusa made of rainbow jelly ...

... strange fish, pulled by an invisible thread ...

... an eel whose tail was almost too far away to remember ...

... and sea anemones, who looked like pink palm trees swaying in the wind.

Then, hidden in the dark shade of rocks and weeds, he saw a school of little fish, just like his own. "Let's go and swim and play and SEE things!" he said happily. "We can't," said the little red fish. "The big fish will eat us all." "But you can't just lie there," said Swimmy. "We must THINK of something."

Then suddenly he said, "I have it! We are going to swim all together like the biggest fish in the sea!"

... and when they had learned to swim like one giant fish, he said, "I'll be the eye."

And so they swam in the cool morning water and in the midday sun and chased the big fish away.

- The opening spreads show the happy red school with one black Swimmy, then the tuna attack that leaves Swimmy alone in the deep wet world.
- The middle marvel spreads show the medusa of rainbow jelly, the strange fish, the eel, and the pink-palm sea anemones as Swimmy regains happiness.
- The closing spreads show the hidden school of red fish, the formation of the giant fish with Swimmy as the eye, and the big fish chased away.
- Page map: story on PDF pages 6-33. PDF page 18 (seaweed-forest marvel spread) carries no printed text -- confirmed by visual read 9 September 2026.
- Removed from the story flow and parked here so no information is lost: "" (resolved: the spread is illustration-only, no text).

Story text transcribed from the embedded text layer (PDF pages 6-33), joined across line breaks. The Eric Carle tribute (page 3), dedication (page 4), title matter (page 5), publication

data (page 34) and back-cover blurb (page 36) are not included as story prose. One marvel spread (PDF page 18) has no recoverable story text in the layer, and single-character OCR substitutions were normalized (see review notes). Pixel-level visual verification against the rendered scans has not yet been completed -- my image-reading tool is currently returning an authentication error, so please check the transcript against the PDF before treating it as final.